

Friedhelm Ten Brinken — Combat Identity

Friedhelm is the second most dangerous Lieder alive, but the uncontested master of double axes.

He fights with two axes, cursed speech, and techniques tied to the ancient Ten Brinken bloodline. Unlike Leora, whose mastery developed through archery and battlefield control, Friedhelm's combat is built around **closing distance, taking control, and dismantling opponents at close range.**

He is the greatest practitioner of Lausatök in Ten Brinken history.

Lausatök ("loose grip" or "free grip") is the most aggressive combat form of Glíma. It abandons ceremonial restrictions and focuses on battlefield survival through:

- throws
- joint locks
- takedowns
- pain techniques
- weapon disarms
- grappling
- positional control

Friedhelm does not separate combat and killing.

He separates **movement** from **execution**.

A fight against Friedhelm has stages.

First:

Can you stand?

Then:

Can you breathe?

Then:

Can you hold a weapon?

Then:

Can you move?

Only after the opponent has been reduced to something helpless does Friedhelm kill.

He does not fight bodies.

He dismantles functions.

His question during combat is:

"What does this body stop doing if I hurt it here?"

Ancient Blood Phases

1. Moonlight

Blue eyes brighten like moonlight.

Friedhelm is still completely himself, but his inherited instincts sharpen.

His movements become faster, more precise, and more animalistic.

This is the phase where the fox appears:

- testing
- misleading
- redirecting
- controlling

Techniques:

- Fox Pin
- Broken Antlers
- Bite Lock

- **Nine Fox Steps**

2. Sun Wolf

Gold eyes.

Friedhelm stops fighting like a man and begins hunting like the Skuggabaldur.

The hesitation disappears.

Every movement becomes predatory.

The fox becomes a killer.

This is where his physical techniques become terrifying.

Techniques:

- Fox Pin
 - Broken Antlers
 - Bite Lock
 - Blood Eagle
-

3. Black Fox

Black sclera.
Crimson irises.
Dark veins.

The ancient blood fully remembers.

This is the closest Friedhelm comes to the Progenitor.

Gods recognize this state immediately.

Not because of power.

Because they recognize the predator beneath the human shape.

Techniques:

- All previous techniques
 - Brink Severance
-

Signature Techniques

Fox Pin

Phase: Moonlight / Sun Wolf

Friedhelm enters an opponent's space before they understand he has moved.

He abandons his axes.

He places both hands on the opponent's shoulders.

For a brief moment, it resembles the ritualized "fox boxing" stance — two predators standing upright, chest to chest, measuring each other.

The opponent believes Friedhelm is pushing them backward.

They are wrong.

The grip is not on the shoulders.

The shoulders are only the anchor.

Friedhelm locks the upper body, forces the spine straight, and twists.

Not the torso.

Not the shoulders.

The neck.

The force is sudden and precise.

The head separates before the opponent understands what happened.

Friedhelm releases them, calmly picks up his axes, and continues walking as the body collapses.

The horror of Fox Pin is that it looks like a gesture of restraint.

It is actually an execution.

Broken Antlers

Phase: Moonlight / Sun Wolf

A Lausatök pain-control technique.

Friedhelm does not break limbs immediately.

He destroys their usefulness.

Every strike targets a joint, nerve, tendon, or connection point.

Examples:

- thumb driven into the joint beneath the collarbone to disable the arm
- fingers crushed inward until a weapon drops
- wrist twisted beyond grip strength
- elbow forced backward past its natural range
- knee attacked from the side to destroy balance
- Achilles tendon trapped and compressed to prevent movement

The purpose is not torture.

The purpose is reduction.

Every injury removes an option.

A warrior with a broken weapon can still fight.

A warrior who cannot stand, grip, or breathe cannot.

Bite Lock

Phase: Sun Wolf

A technique inherited from wolves and Skuggabaldur instincts.

Friedhelm uses his teeth as a restraint.

Not a killing move.

A control move.

He bites:

- forearms to stop weapons
- shoulders to prevent movement
- the side of the neck to force submission

The terrifying aspect is not the bite itself.

It is that he continues fighting normally while holding someone in place with his jaws.

An opponent expects hands to be the only danger.

They forget predators have teeth.

Blood Eagle

Phase: Sun Wolf / Black Fox

Friedhelm's signature chest execution.

Unlike Leora's heart techniques, Friedhelm does not remove what is inside the body.

He opens the body itself.

Blood Eagle begins as a Lausatök position.

Friedhelm must first force chest-to-chest contact.

Once he has control, escape becomes almost impossible.

His axes are not used to hack.

They are placed.

Precise.

Controlled.

The ribs are separated from the spine through leverage and force, opening the chest cavity.

The victim remains conscious long enough to understand they have lost control of their own body.

The technique represents Friedhelm perfectly:

Not destruction.

Exposure.

He does not take something from the body.

He makes the body unable to hide.

Nine Fox Steps

Phase: Moonlight

A movement technique based on fox hunting behavior.

Friedhelm does not create illusions.

He creates uncertainty.

A fox does not run directly toward prey.

It changes direction.

Tests.

Circles.

Appears where it should not be.

Nine Fox Steps allows Friedhelm to instantly change between nine prepared positions on the battlefield.

Not teleportation.

Preparation.

He has already mapped where the fight will go.

Opponents believe they are reacting to him.

They are actually moving through a path he created.

Fox's Smile

Phase: Sun Wolf

A killing technique.

Friedhelm creates a small diagonal cut across the throat.

Almost nothing.

The victim can still speak.

Still breathe.

Still believe they are alive.

Friedhelm watches.

Then he smiles.

The cut opens.

The throat separates.

The fight ends.

The technique reflects the Skuggabaldur:

The most dangerous wound is not the one you notice.

It is the one you discover too late.

Signature Kills

Throat Kill

All phases.

A Ten Brinken execution inherited from the Progenitor.

Friedhelm uses:

- teeth
- axe edge
- hands

depending on the situation.

Because the throat contains:

- breath
- voice
- identity

A Ten Brinken who destroys the throat is not only killing a body.

They are silencing existence.

Rib Claim

Black Fox only

The evolved form of Blood Eagle.

Friedhelm does not simply break the body.

He claims the structure holding it together.

Friedhelm removes the lungs of his opponents and claims their last breath.

When he enters Black Fox, he can even perceive the life runes within a death deity.

The ribs become the access point.

He physically tears open the chest and reaches through the destruction to extract the rune hidden beneath.

Where Leora dismantles gods through precision, Friedhelm dismantles them through forceful opening.

He does not remove pieces from the outside.

He breaks the fortress and enters.

Brink Severance — The Technique That Frightens Gods

Black Fox only

Every death deity possesses nine life runes:

- 2 leg runes — movement
- 2 arm runes — action
- 2 hand runes — control
- heart rune — persistence
- throat rune — authority
- head rune — identity

In Black Fox, Friedhelm can see these runes.

If he reaches one, he can tear it from the deity.

Removing a rune permanently damages the god:

- leg rune → loss of movement between realms
- arm rune → loss of divine action
- hand rune → loss of control
- heart rune → weakened existence
- throat rune → diminished authority
- head rune → fractured identity

Friedhelm does not kill gods.

He breaks the pieces that make them gods using Rib Claim as the method.

Combat Song

You are completely right — I inverted the central mythology, and that actually changes the emotional core of the song.

I treated "fox" and "wolf" as symbolic roles for Friedhelm and Skugga, when the actual mythology is much more beautiful:

- **Friedhelm is the fox.**
- **Skugga is the fox.**
- **Wulf is the wolf Friedhelm loves.**
- **Vargr is the wolf Skugga loves.**
- The foxes are mirrors of each other.
- The wolves are mirrors of each other.
- The moon created Vargr and Skugga together, and their love exists as the divine echo of what Friedhelm and Wulf have.
- The world sees the pairing as strange: fox and wolf, two beings who should not belong together.
- But the oldest truth is that they always do.

That means the ending should not be "the fox who loved the wolf" as a single statement. It should be almost a **recognition between Skugga and Friedhelm**:

"You are the fox who found the wolf. I am the fox who found the wolf. The moon knew before the world did."

The song is not Friedhelm begging Skugga to remember him.

Skugga already remembered him when no one else did.

The song is Friedhelm saying:

"I know what you did because I am like you."

And that makes it much more personal.

I would revise the imagery like this:

Refur í Skugga

Fox in Shadow

Friedhelm Ten Brinken's Battle Chant

Ek sat þar sem árnar gleyma.

I sat where rivers forget.

Þar sem svört reyrin hvísla við dauðans bakka.

Where black reeds whisper beside death's bank.

Þar sem vatnið ber engin andlit.

Where the water carries no faces.

Þar sem nöfn falla úr munni heimsins.

Where names fall from the mouth of the world.

Þá kom skuggi.

Then came the shadow.

Ekki með eldi.

Not with fire.

Ekki með þrumum.

Not with thunder.

Heldur með höndum.

But with hands.

Höndum sem fundu það sem týndist.

Hands that found what was lost.

Höndum sem söfnuðu brotunum sem heimurinn kastaði burt.

Hands that gathered the fragments the world threw away.

Skuggi.

Refur undir dauðum mána.

Fox beneath the dying moon.

Refur í myrkrinu þar sem allir aðrir týnast.

Fox in the darkness where all others are lost.

Sá sem vakir við árnar endalaus.

The one who watches beside the endless rivers.

Þekktir þú mig þá?

Did you know me then?

Áður en ég var nafn?

Before I was a name?

Áður en ég var rödd?

Before I was a voice?

Áður en ég var aðeins skuggi eftir mann?

Before I was only the shadow left behind a man?

Ég var bundinn.

I was bound.

Ég var þaggaður.

I was silenced.

Ég var brotinn niður í ekkert.

I was broken into nothing.

En þú...

þú safnaðir mér.

But you...

you gathered me.

Svört reyr beygjast.

Black reeds bend.

Rauður refeldur rennur yfir ána.

Red foxfire flows across the river.

Dauðinn opnar augu sín.

Death opens its eyes.

Og skugginn stendur.

And the shadow stands.

Skuggi... sérðu mig?

Shadow...

do you see me?

Þú hélt mér þegar ég var enginn.

You held me when I was no one.

Þú mundir mig þegar heimurinn gleymdi.

You remembered me when the world forgot.

Þú geymdir nafnið mitt í myrkrinu.

You kept my name in the darkness.

Ég er ekki tómið.

I am not emptiness.

Ég er ekki gröfin sem þeir skildu eftir.

I am not the grave they left behind.

Ég er klóin sem man höndina.

I am the claw that remembers the hand.

Ég er söngurinn sem lifði þögnina.

I am the song that survived silence.

Ég er refurinn sem fann úlfinn sinn.

I am the fox who found his wolf.

Skuggi.

Your fox walks.

Refur þinn gengur enn.

Your fox still walks.

Nafnið sem þú geymdir andar enn.

The name you kept still breathes.

Heyrið.

Listen.

Þið sem standið fyrir refnum.

You who stand before the fox.

Þið sjáið mann.

You see a man.

Nei.

No.

Þið sjáið þann sem dauðinn missti.

You see the one death failed to keep.

Þið sjáið þann sem skugginn safnaði.

You see the one the shadow gathered.

Þið sjáið þann sem gleymdist ekki.

You see the one who was not forgotten.

Ég gekk þar sem þið getið ekki gengið.

I walked where you cannot walk.

Ég svaf þar sem engin rödd vakir.

I slept where no voice wakes.

Ég var í höndum endalokanna.

I was in the hands of endings.

Og endirinn skilaði mér.

And the ending returned me.

(Quietly.)

Mundu mig, Skuggi.

Remember me, Shadow.

Ekki vegna sársauka.

Not because of suffering.

Ekki vegna dauða.

Not because of death.

Mundu mig vegna þess að við vitum.

Remember me because we know.

Refur þinn fann úlf sinn.

Your fox found his wolf.

Refur minn fann sinn.

My fox found his.

Tveir refir.

Two foxes.

Tveir úlfar.

Two wolves.

Eitt tungl.

One moon.

Sama gamla lagið.

The same ancient song.

"Tunglið vissi áður en heimurinn vissi."

"The moon knew before the world knew."

.